A SMALL-PARTY PRINTABLE

Day-of Run of Show

Every good party keeps a shape in its back pocket: what warms up, when people arrive, when the food lands, what sends everyone home smiling. One card, taped where day-of-you will actually stand, so the plan lives on paper instead of in a head that already has its hands full.

How to use it

1. Fill the times in pencil during Week 1 of the countdown. Parties move; the card bends.
2. Keep it one page. If it doesn't fit on one page, it isn't the run of show — it's the whole party trying to be witnessed twice.
3. The **Who** column is where guests get handed a job: “you're on drinks” is a compliment. Nobody wants to be decorative in your kitchen.
4. Tick rows as you go. The ticking is the treat, and page 3 collects the wobbles plan-B's so the plan stays loose.
5. Skip a row entirely if the day runs differently. The card has never once told on anyone.

What's inside

- **Page 2** — the card itself: a loose time line plus the party's arc in five beats.
- **Page 3** — the pockets: first-hour jobs, sideways moments, and a good-bye plan.

> **A kind note:** the run of show serves the people, not the other way around. Skip a row and no one will ever know.

Print at 100% (“Actual size”), US Letter, portrait. Prints nicely in black & white. Personal use: print as many copies as you like.

Day-of Run of Show

Pencil in the times. Tick as you go. The card bends.

Time	What happens	Who	Done
early	*oven on, music on low, last tidy*		☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐
late	*one last round, then goodbyes*		☐

The loose shape (fill times as fits)

- ☐ Warm structures before anyone arrives — oven on, lights warm, music low.
- ☐ Welcome first, drinks always — give people something to hold in their hands.
- ☐ Food lands mid-party — the middle is where people are hungry, not the front.
- ☐ One toast or one game — a beat, not a program.
- ☐ Announce an ending — “we wrap up around _____” makes goodbyes easy.

Day-of Pockets

Small plans for small wobbles, so the big day stays big-hearted.

First-hour jobs (before the doorbell)

- ☐ Trash emptied and out of sight — the least festive chore, done invisible.
- ☐ Bathroom stocked: paper, hand towel, nothing embarrassing at eye level.
- ☐ Drinks self-serve — a visible station is freedom for everyone including you.
- ☐ Music low enough to talk over; talking is the whole show.
- ☐ Eat something real. The host plate is not a rumor.

When things go sideways

- Food runs late: _____ *(crackers on the counter buy an hour of grace)*
- More people than chairs: _____ *(standing crowds are the festive ones)*
- Conversation stalls: _____ *(louder music, then a raise-your-glass toast)*

The good-bye plan

Party ends around: _____ Last call for containers & leftovers: _____

Send-off moment (last song, dessert box, porch wave):

_____

Thank-them line, said at the door: _____

Said fondly: a party that ends while everyone's happy beats one that ends when everyone's gone. Start the goodbyes while they're still fun to have.